

CODY POSEY | REALTOR

The New Braunfels & Hill Country Relocation Guide

Educating. Serving. Delivering Results.

cposeyrealestate.com

830-360-5569 | codyposey@cposeyrealestate.com

2026 Edition | Figures current as of September 2026

Why New Braunfels?

New Braunfels sits on the I-35 corridor between San Antonio and Austin, in the heart of Texas Hill Country. It has been one of the fastest-growing cities in the United States for over a decade — and the growth is driven by fundamentals: jobs, affordability relative to Austin, strong schools, and a quality of life built around two spring-fed rivers.

116K+

Population
2024 Census estimate

~30 min

To San Antonio
via I-35*

~45 min

To Austin
via I-35*

\$380K

Median listing price
Sept 2026

*Off-peak drive times. I-35 congestion can stretch both — ask me about commute-tested neighborhoods.

This guide covers what actually matters when you relocate here: cost of living, schools, employment, neighborhoods, the military/VA picture, and a moving checklist. No fluff — just the numbers and local knowledge you need to make a confident move.

Cost of Living

- Texas has no state income tax. More of your paycheck stays with you, period.
- Property taxes: your total rate depends on your exact taxing districts (county, city, school district, and any special districts). For tax year 2025, Comal County's county-only rate was \$0.305015 per \$100 of valuation — just one slice of the total bill. Always verify the adopted rates for a specific address before you budget.
- Overall cost of living sits below the national average: affordable groceries, utilities, and transportation.
- Housing costs run well below Austin prices, which is why families and remote workers priced out of larger metros keep landing here.
- Warning that matters: Hill Country flash flooding is real. I check flood zones as part of my buyer due diligence — make sure your agent does too.

Schools & Education

- Comal Independent School District (ISD) serves most of the area and is well-regarded, with multiple highly rated campuses.
- New Braunfels ISD covers parts of the city and is known for strong community involvement.
- Private and charter options are available, including several faith-based schools.
- Higher education nearby: Texas State University (San Marcos, ~20 min), UTSA, and multiple community colleges.

Employment & Economy

- Major local employers: Comal ISD, Resolute Health Hospital, HEB, and the City of New Braunfels.
- The I-35 corridor between San Antonio and Austin is a fast-growing economic hub — tech, healthcare, and military-adjacent jobs.
- Joint Base San Antonio (Fort Sam Houston, Lackland AFB, Randolph AFB, Camp Bullis) is one of the largest military footprints in the country and a massive regional employer.
- Remote workers increasingly choose New Braunfels: Hill Country quality of life on an Austin or San Antonio salary.

Neighborhoods & Communities

- Vintage Oaks — master-planned Hill Country living with resort amenities and 1–3 acre lots.
- Gruene — historic district on the Guadalupe River, walkable to Gruene Hall and local shops.
- River Chase & Westpointe — family-friendly subdivisions with pools, parks, and newer construction.
- Downtown New Braunfels — charming historic homes, walkable to restaurants and the Comal River.
- Bulverde / Garden Ridge / Canyon Lake — Hill Country space and acreage within a reasonable commute.
- Rural acreage is available throughout the Hill Country for buyers who want room and privacy.

Military & VA Buyers

As a retired Army First Sergeant with 20 years of service, this is my home turf. San Antonio is “Military City USA,” and thousands of military families buy in the New Braunfels corridor every year — close enough for a reasonable commute to Fort Sam Houston, Randolph, or Lackland, with more house for your BAH than you will find inside the Loop.

- VA loans: 0% down, no PMI, competitive rates. As a Military Relocation Professional, I specialize in VA transactions and know where they get stuck — and how to keep them moving.
- BAH goes further here: compare your housing allowance against real neighborhood prices before you sign a lease. My BAH rates breakdown is at cposeyrealestate.com/military-relocation/bah-rates/.
- PCS timeline: I do video walkthroughs for out-of-state buyers so you can make an offer with confidence before you arrive.
- Per-installation housing guides (Fort Sam Houston, Lackland AFB, Randolph AFB, Camp Bullis) are on my site under Military Relocation.

Moving Checklist

- 60+ days out: research neighborhoods against your commute; get pre-approved (or start your VA loan paperwork).
- 45 days out: if PCSing, request TLA/housing brief dates; book movers early — summer fills up fast.
- 30 days out: narrow to 2-3 target areas; schedule video tours if buying sight-unseen.
- 2 weeks out: transfer utilities (New Braunfels Utilities / GVEC / CPS depending on address); update USPS, banks, voter registration.
- Move week: walk the property before closing; verify flood zone and insurance quotes in hand.
- After arrival: get your Texas driver license and plates within 90 days; find your HEB — priorities matter.

READY TO MAKE THE MOVE?

Cody Posey, REALTOR

Retired Army First Sergeant (20 years). Texas REALTOR with Popby Realty.
Military Relocation Professional (MRP) | Accredited Buyer's Representative (ABR)
Pricing Strategy Advisor (PSA).

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"New to the license, not new to leadership."

Book a free relocation consult — video tours available for out-of-state buyers.